

DEBAJYOTI CHAKRABORTY

CHANDANA BAURI, 30

BJP MLA, Saltora, West Bengal

Rich in Intention

She caught the BJP's eye when, as general secretary of the Mahila Morcha in her village Kelai in Bankura district, she went door to door to enlist villagers for a membership drive. She even helped two candidates from neighbouring villages win the 2018 panchayat poll despite inter-party violence.

She was a natural choice, therefore, when BJP was seeking candidates for the 2021 assembly poll in West Bengal, especially as Mamata Banerjee fielded 50 women. Chandana, wife of a daily wager and mother of three children, lived up to the expectation, as she won her maiden election from Saltora constituency, defeating Santosh Mondal of Trinamool Congress to become one of the 77 BJP candidates who managed to win in the face of an overwhelming TMC sweep.

"What amazes me is her zeal to uplift the poor when she herself can't make ends meet"

MIHIR GOSWAMI
BJP MLA from Cooch Behar (South)

Being a BJP MLA, though, has scarcely brought about any change in Chandana's modest lifestyle. She continues to live in a humble dwelling she got under the PM Awas Yojana, with unplastered walls and without window panes. She does not spend the MLA salary she earns on herself. She would rather extend a helping hand to families too poor to marry off their daughters or unable to bear medical expenses. Nobody understands better than her what it means to be poor. ■

– Romita Datta

LOO LESS ABODE She does not have a toilet in her home. There's one in her backyard which she has to share with the CRPF men in charge of her security.

DOCTOR DOGOOD

SHRIKANT SHINDE, 34

Lok Sabha MP, Shiv Sena, Mumbai

When Shrikant Shinde, an orthopaedic surgeon by training, decided to join politics in 2014, he knew in which direction he wanted to take his party, the Shiv Sena—from being street fighters to health warriors.

Under the banner of his Dr Shrikant Shinde Foundation, Shinde has helped lakhs of poor and needy patients get medical help under several Maharashtra government schemes. Extended now to 14 of the state's 36 districts, such is the demand for his work in the field of health that a tea stall vendor in rural Satara offered his premises as an office



SANTOSH KUMAR/GETTY IMAGES

SHREYASI SINGH, 30

BJP MLA, Jamui, Bihar